BASED ON THE VIRAL INTERVIEW



THE HUBERMAN BLUEPRINT

A Neuroscientist's Complete System to Train Your Brain for Peak Performance, Unbreakable Resilience & Deep Rest

INSIGHTS FROM **DR. ANDREW HUBERMAN**
STANFORD NEUROSCIENTIST & HOST OF HUBERMAN LAB

The Huberman Blueprint

Based on the in-depth conversation between
Dr. Andrew Huberman and **Raj Shamani**

This book distills the key principles, protocols, and frameworks shared during the interview into an actionable guide. All scientific concepts and personal insights are attributed to Dr. Huberman as discussed in the original conversation.

Disclaimer: This book is for educational purposes only and does not constitute medical advice. Always consult a healthcare professional before making changes to your health routine.

First Edition · 2026

Contents

01 **The Cortisol Code** The single most important thing for performance

02 **The Art of Turning Off** Why your off switch is your greatest weapon

03 **Yoga Nidra & The Sleep Reset** The no-pill protocol for deep restoration

04 **The 10-Year Mastery Framework** Years 1–3, 4–6, and 7+ decoded

05 **The Neuroscience of Choking** Why we freeze when the stakes are highest

06 **Building Courage & Resilience** Cold water, mental games & the slightly harder thing

07 **Clutch States Over Flow States** The real mental state of high performers

08 **The Winner's Mentality** Transmuting hardship into generative action

09 **The Immigrant Edge & Identity** Why mindset beats circumstance

10 **The Cost of Greatness** Emotions, ambition, and making peace with it all

01

The Cortisol Code

The single most important behavior for your health, performance, and resilience — and almost nobody knows it.

If Andrew Huberman had only five minutes to talk to someone — just five minutes to share the single most impactful thing they could do for their health, well-being, and performance — he wouldn't talk about supplements. He wouldn't talk about cold plunges or meditation apps. He'd talk about *cortisol timing*.

The message is deceptively simple: **High morning cortisol. Low nighttime cortisol.**

That's it. That's the entire framework. But within those eight words lies the architecture of human performance.

> *"If I only had 5 minutes to talk to somebody, I would say: this is the best thing you can do for your health and well-being and performance. High morning cortisol, low nighttime cortisol."*
>
> — ANDREW HUBERMAN

Cortisol Is Not the Enemy

Most people have been taught that cortisol is a "stress hormone" — something to minimize, suppress, avoid. Ashwagandha to crush it. Meditation to eliminate it. But this understanding is dangerously incomplete.

Cortisol's *primary* job is not to deal with stress. Its main function is to deploy glucose and lipids from areas in your body that give you energy. **It's an energy-deploying hormone.** When it spikes in the morning — what scientists call the *cortisol awakening response* — it's literally the reason you wake up.

Here's what happens when this rhythm is dialed in:

- **Vastly higher levels** of daytime energy, focus, and ability to learn

- **Greater resilience** to stress when it comes along
- **Easier sleep onset** with deeper sleep and more REM
- **Optimized immune system function** — you get sick less
- **Faster recovery** — the emotional load of difficult days gets processed

---

The Negative Feedback Loop

The genius of biology is this: cortisol operates on a *negative feedback loop*. Once you create that high morning peak, it inhibits itself. The peak ensures that afternoon and evening cortisol drops naturally. It's a wavefront that starts the entire 24-hour cycle.

The worst-case scenario? A *flattened* cortisol curve — no real peak in the morning, a highish baseline all day, cortisol still elevated at night. Any stress that comes rides on an already elevated baseline. This disrupts blood glucose regulation, immune function, and sleep architecture. This is what "chronic stress" actually is — not stress itself, but **afternoon and nighttime high cortisol**.

> 💡 KEY INSIGHT
>
> Cortisol and melatonin are on opposite cycles. High morning cortisol suppresses melatonin (promoting alertness). Low evening cortisol allows melatonin to rise (promoting deep sleep). Master this seesaw and you master your daily rhythm.

The Morning Protocol

⚡ PROTOCOL: SPIKE YOUR MORNING CORTISOL

1. **Get bright light in your eyes** within the first 30–60 minutes of waking. Go outside. Remove sunglasses and brimmed hats. Eyeglasses and contacts are fine. Look in the direction of the sun (never stare directly). 5–10 minutes is sufficient.
2. **Hydrate immediately.** Water boosts cortisol. Drink 16–32 oz upon waking.
3. **Drink caffeine** in the first hour. Caffeine further amplifies the cortisol peak.
4. **Move your body.** A walk, jumping jacks, or exercise in the first hour is ideal. Exercise provides an additional spike.
5. **Avoid looking at your phone in bed.** Get upright. Get moving. Get outside.

Cloudy days: Even more important to get outside — overcast skies still deliver far more lux than indoor lighting. **No sunlight?** Use a 10,000 lux artificial light (tablet-sized, available commercially).

The Evening Wind-Down

🌙 PROTOCOL: LOWER EVENING CORTISOL

1. **Dim the lights** in the final hour before sleep. Bright light hits specialized neurons in the eye (intrinsically photosensitive melanopsin retinal ganglion cells) that suppress melatonin.
2. **Avoid caffeine** in the final 8 hours before sleep.
3. **Practice long-exhale breathing.** Extending your exhales activates the vagus nerve and slows your heart rate. Even 3–5 deliberate long exhales during the day increases your nighttime HRV.
4. **Cool your body.** Core body temperature dropping is what brings melatonin up. A slightly cool room helps enormously.
5. **Avoid excessive fluids** close to bedtime to prevent waking for the bathroom.

A Note on Ashwagandha

Ashwagandha potently reduces cortisol — by about 30% at 600mg. This is exactly why you should *never* take it in the morning. If you use it, take it in the second half of the day. At high doses (600mg+), limit to two-week cycles with two weeks off. Moderate doses (300–600mg) are fine to take consistently, but always in the afternoon or evening.

This is the foundation. Without this rhythm in place, every other protocol — every supplement, every workout plan, every mindset hack — will produce marginal results at best. **Get cortisol timing right first.** Everything else builds on top.

02

The Art of Turning Off

Anyone can push. The person who wins is the one who knows how to stop.

Let's make it competitive. Give Andrew two people. Both work incredibly hard. Both are equally committed to their goals. Both have perfect circumstances — access to food, exercise, everything they need.

The person who can turn their mind off in the final hour of their day and get the better, deeper sleep? He's putting all his money on that person.

> *"The person that can turn their mind off in the final hour of their day and get the better, deeper sleep — I'm going to put all my money on that person within 5 to 10 years, far surpassing the other."*
>
> — ANDREW HUBERMAN

This is counterintuitive in a culture obsessed with "get after it." We celebrate the person who drinks 12 cups of coffee, pops an Adderall, and outworks everybody. But see that person on Thursday. On Friday. On the following week. They're borrowing from tomorrow. And the debt compounds.

The Left Column vs. Right Column

A former tier-one Navy SEAL operator named Andy Stump shared an exercise with Huberman that he now does monthly. It's brutally simple:

Take out a sheet of paper. Draw a line down the middle.

- **Left Column:** All the things that concern you — what people think, worries, fears, things you saw online
- **Right Column:** All the things you can actually control — exercise, hydrate, sleep, call your mother, do your work

What you realize: you have almost *zero* control over the things in the left column. And the mind is *obsessed* with the left column.

For the month after doing this exercise, you naturally start noticing when your thoughts are in the left column versus the right. Your team starts saying it: "That's a left-column issue." It becomes a filter. It becomes a practice.

> 🧠 NEUROSCIENCE CONCEPT
>
> **Dynamic Attractor States:** Think of your thoughts and emotions as a ball bearing on a flat surface. As you focus on something — worry, anger, fear — the surface becomes concave. Then a trench. The ball bearing gets locked. Typically it takes something robust (a friend's call, good sleep, exercise) to knock that ball bearing back to flat. But you *can* learn to do it yourself. Get present. Notice what you hear, smell, feel. Think in literal actions. You are in charge of your mind.

The Binary Choice

When stress hits, when a flight gets delayed, when you're overwhelmed — you have exactly two choices. Not three. Two:

1. **Completely relax.** Scroll social media. Watch a movie. Call a friend. Truly decompress.
2. **Really focus in and get work done.** Deep work. Full engagement.

What you *never* do is the hybrid. The half-working-half-scrolling. The trying-to-focus-but-can't. **When the mind is split between two places, that's the most taxing thing.** The brain thrives on unitary states. We need to train ourselves to get into them.

The Weekly Reset Day

One day per week: no exercise. As much time as possible in fresh air, sunshine, and relaxation. If that's not possible, just veg out. Watch a movie. Be a child for half a day. Huberman calls it "our zero cortisol day." (There's no such thing as zero cortisol — he still gets the morning sunlight peak — but the rest of the day is dedicated to pure recovery.)

This is not laziness. This is strategy. A Formula 1 driver doesn't just make pit stops. The car needs care. It needs love. It needs rest. *When* you rest and *how* you rest is absolutely key.

03

Yoga Nidra & The Sleep Reset

There is no pill that will do this. There is no pill that will do this.

If the cortisol rhythm is the foundation, Yoga Nidra (also called Non-Sleep Deep Rest or NSDR) is the single most powerful tool for mental and physical recovery. Huberman calls it the most important practice he's ever adopted.

The practice originated in India. It involves lying or sitting down, performing long-exhale breathing, slowing the heart rate deliberately, and then making a conscious shift: moving from a mode of *thinking and planning* into a mode of *pure sensation*.

> *"No drug will do this, at least not in a healthy way. Any drug that takes you out of thinking and planning and just into pure sensation — that drug is going to rebound you into a rough place when you come out of it."*
>
> — ANDREW HUBERMAN

What Yoga Nidra Actually Does

New research shows that during Yoga Nidra, pockets of the brain go into deep sleep and possibly even REM sleep — while you're technically still conscious. This makes it extraordinarily restorative. It's not meditation (which requires focused attention). It's the deliberate practice of *turning off* — releasing thinking, planning, and doing, and dropping into sensation.

The benefits compound over time. The neural circuits involved in self-directed relaxation are amenable to **plasticity**. They get stronger with practice. Huberman started in 2017 and reports that after years of consistent practice, he can now turn his mind off at will — falling back asleep when he wakes at 2 a.m., recovering from poor nights of sleep within 20 minutes of practice.

🧘 **PROTOCOL: YOGA NIDRA / NSDR**

- **Duration:** 10, 20, or 30 minutes
- **Frequency:** 1–7 days per week
- **When:** Any time. If you didn't sleep well, do it first thing upon waking. Otherwise, do it during a natural afternoon dip (2–3 PM is ideal).
- **How:** Find a free guided Yoga Nidra script on YouTube. Lie down. Close your eyes. Follow the instructions. The work is simply noticing when your mind shifts into planning/thinking and gently returning to sensation.
- **After:** Hydrate. Maybe a small amount of caffeine. You'll feel restored.

The Eye Movement Sleep Trick

This is one of the most unusual — and effective — tools Huberman shares. When you can't fall asleep or get back to sleep:

👁️ **PROTOCOL: PROPRIOCEPTIVE SLEEP RESET**

1. Keep your eyes **closed**
2. Slowly move your eyes to one side, then to the other side
3. Move your eyes counterclockwise
4. Then clockwise
5. Look toward the tip of your nose (you're not crossing your eyes)
6. Perform a long, deliberate exhale

Why it works: This disrupts your *proprioceptive circuits* — the system that tells you where your limbs are in space. To fall asleep, you need to *forget your body position*. This is the first critical step in falling asleep that nobody talks about. The eye movements exploit the connection between your eyes and cerebellum, which controls balance and body awareness.

Huberman reports that many people who've tried this simply wake up the next morning, not remembering when they fell asleep. He used it on the plane ride to the interview and was "out."

04

The 10-Year Mastery Framework

The biggest lie about peak performance is that the goal is to just build bigger and bigger capacity.

Here's something counterintuitive: the better you get at something, the more of an inroad into your energy it creates. Not less. More.

When you're first learning something, it takes brute-force energy. Then you get fluid — you can sit down and podcast or code or operate under most conditions. But to *really* drop into your craft? That requires deeper focus. And deeper focus creates a bigger energy withdrawal.

This is why the common advice — just build a bigger engine, add more capacity — is incomplete. You need a framework that evolves with your skill level.

The 10-Year Mastery Framework

YRS 1–3 **All Gas Pedal.** Go all in. Work, learn, learn, learn. Just don't die. Find your edge — how little sleep can you survive on? How hard can you push? These are discovery years. Reset only as needed to keep coming back. You're building raw capacity through volume and intensity.

YRS 4–6 **Dynamic Regulation.** You've found your walls. Now learn to work around your average capacity ±2 hours. This is when chronic illness, autoimmune conditions, hair loss, and skin issues start appearing if you don't learn balance. Your nighttime cortisol is too high. The rhythm is off. Learn to bring it back.

YRS 7–10+ **The Pro Stage.** You know when you're stressed. You know when you need Nidra. You know when to put the phone away. You can start guiding your team. You integrate mastery with playfulness. The ultra-disciplined, superfocused — but with an element of play. Because you're so secure, you can just have fun. That's where extraordinary work comes from.

The Resistance Training Parallel

After 10–15 years of lifting, you don't need more sets. You need to **pour more into fewer sets**. You've developed the ability to generate focused intensity — to truly cramp the muscle, to push through the hard reps. A beginner can't do that. They need volume. An expert needs precision and then *more rest*.

The same applies to cognitive work. Early in your career: more volume, more hours. As you mature: more focused intensity in fewer hours. And correspondingly — more deliberate recovery.

> *"The unit of time to focus on is the day. What can I do today? I'm not thinking about tomorrow as its own thing. I know it's coming. But what can I do today to get the most done, knowing I'm coming back tomorrow and I've got to do it again?"*
>
> — ANDREW HUBERMAN

05

The Neuroscience of Choking

The freezing doesn't come from fear of failure. It comes from imagining how good it could go.

Two people. Same risk in front of them. One jumps. The other freezes. What's happening in the brain of the person who freezes?

The answer, backed by research, is the opposite of what most people think.

A published neuroscience paper on "choking under pressure" reveals something startling: when the rewards get high — when you start thinking about what you stand to *gain*, not what you stand to *lose* — the brain over-recruits neurons in the motor cortex. The signal becomes too loud. Too many circuits fire at once. And highly skilled people *miss*.

> *"People think they're imagining how terrible it could go. But what causes us to choke is: so much is at stake. 'If I can't do this, I can't do anything.' They're psyching themselves out with how great it could be."*
>
> — ANDREW HUBERMAN

Lower the Stakes

The solution is elegant: **lower the stakes in your mind.**

Don't commit to three years of going all-in. Commit to three *days*. If you survive three days, you can survive three more. Bring the time horizon in. This is what Huberman calls the "chop wood, carry water" mentality — a phrase that means: some days you don't think about why. You just do the next thing.

When he was writing his 650-page book alongside running the podcast, resentments would come up. *Why'd I agree to this? I can get out of this.* He'd push it aside. Chop wood, carry water. Just today. One more day.

🎯 THE ANTIDOTE TO FREEZING

When you're paralyzed by a big decision, shorten the horizon. Don't think about the five-year plan. Think about the next three days. Lower the stakes until action becomes possible. Then build momentum from there.

06

Building Courage & Resilience

Every opportunity to stress is an opportunity to practice stress resilience.

Can you build courage? Huberman's answer is unequivocal: **Absolutely. Incremental.** You get people to their edge of agitation and you let them just live there.

The Wall Method (Cold Exposure)

Huberman's approach to cold exposure is different from the standard "go for time" advice. His method trains *real-world resilience* — the kind that transfers to public speaking, hard conversations, and high-stakes decisions.

🧊 PROTOCOL: THE WALL METHOD

1. **Wall 1:** Just get in the cold shower. That's the first wall.
2. **Wall 2:** Don't count or go for time. Instead, *sense* when you really want to get out. That's the second wall. Stay just a bit longer.
3. **Wall 3:** Get comfortable again. Wait until that next wave of wanting to get out hits. Go over it.
4. **Wall 4 & 5:** Repeat. Each wave is a pulse of adrenaline. You're training yourself to ride the waves.

Why this is better: Real life doesn't give you a 3-minute timer. Public speaking doesn't come with a countdown. This method teaches you to deal with *whatever comes your way* — waves of stress with no predetermined end point.

Huberman's Three Mental Games for Daily Resilience

🎮 **PROTOCOL: THREE DAILY RESILIENCE GAMES**

1. **The 10-Breath Morning Meditation.** Before you even get out of bed, do a 10-breath meditation. If you can't concentrate for 10 breaths, how will you navigate your day? Set an alarm (long exhales can put you back to sleep). Especially powerful on mornings when you're exhausted.
2. **Maximum Intensity Work Sets.** In your workouts (not warm-ups), make the hard sets *harder*. Don't make them easier. Contract the muscle harder. Focus more intensely. When it's tough, make it tougher. This mindset transfers directly to work and life.
3. **Panoramic Vision Reset.** When overwhelmed — too many texts, too much information — dilate your gaze. Expand your visual field to take in the whole room, the ceiling, the floor. This activates your parasympathetic nervous system, reduces tunnel vision, and frees up cognitive resources. New solutions appear when you literally broaden your view.

The Slightly Harder Thing

Throughout the day, there are tiny opportunities to choose the slightly harder option. Pick up that piece of trash on the floor. Turn off the music for the last three sets. Turn up the heat instead of the AC during a workout. Have the difficult conversation instead of avoiding it. Stay quiet when you want to interrupt.

None of these are dramatic. All of them build the algorithm of resilience in your brain. Your nervous system doesn't just learn facts — it learns *patterns of overcoming friction*. Every micro-rep compounds.

07

Clutch States Over Flow States

Flow is the expression of mastery. Clutch is where mastery is built.

Everyone talks about flow states — that magical zone where everything clicks, time disappears, and peak performance feels effortless. But Huberman learned something during a conversation with Tommy Wood, an MD/PhD at the University of Washington who studies high performance and neuroplasticity: the concept of **clutch states**.

When he heard it, his reaction was immediate: *"Finally, someone described my life."*

> *"Clutch states are the states of forcing oneself to do something at that edge of friction and effort. Most athletes, investors, high performers, business people live in this state 90% of their waking hours."*
>
> — ANDREW HUBERMAN

Why Flow Is Overrated

Flow is the expression of something you can *already* do. It has nothing to do with learning. Zero. Learning happens when you're making errors. A fundamental principle of neuroplasticity is: **if your nervous system can already do something, there's no plasticity. There's no rewiring.**

It's the gap between your desired performance and your current performance that triggers adrenaline (norepinephrine) and other neurochemicals that allow neural circuits to rewire. The errors are what drive adaptation. Your nervous system goes, "I can't do it, I can't do it, I can't do it" — and then after sleep and recovery, you find you can do it a little better.

🔬 THE PROGRESSION

Unskilled → Skilled → Mastery → Virtuosity. Everyone wants virtuosity. But virtuosity is built on years upon years of clutch state — that zone of effortful engagement, friction, and forcing yourself to perform. Flow comes later, as the reward for all those clutch reps. Not the other way around.

Self-Testing: The Best Way to Learn

After listening to a podcast, reading a book chapter, or attending a meeting, take a few minutes to simply recall: *What did I learn?* Where you go blank — "I don't remember" — great. Go look it up. You'll never forget it. This process of recognizing what you do and don't know is what drives lasting learning.

08

The Winner's Mentality

Both losers and winners have hard thoughts and feelings of despair. The difference is what they do with them.

Someone is listening and feeling like a loser right now. Huberman doesn't dodge this. He addresses it head-on with a framework that is simultaneously compassionate and uncompromising.

> *"Losers take things that happened to them and turn those thoughts and emotions into things that harm themselves or others. Winners take the things that happen to them — good or bad — and they transmute that into actions that are supportive and generative for them and for others."*
>
> — ANDREW HUBERMAN

The Transmutation Process

This is not positive thinking. It's not "just think good thoughts." It's a *forced* practice — sometimes multiple times per hour, sometimes every five minutes. You literally have to force yourself over and over to choose generative action over destructive reaction.

The rules are stark:

- You **cannot** self-attack
- You **cannot** attack others
- If you can't get into a generative state, do *nothing*. Feel the feelings. Don't get up. Don't act. But don't harm.
- Eventually, get up and do *something* — anything constructive

When You're at the Absolute Bottom

If you truly cannot pull yourself back — if you're at the bottom of the pit and no mental technique is working — Huberman offers this:

🙏 THE LAST RESORT PROTOCOL

Acknowledge out loud — alone or in your head — "I'm at my end. I can't do this on my own anymore. Just help me get through the next hour." Say it to God, the universe, or whatever you believe in. Stop trying to control everything. Give it over. Just get through one more hour. Then one more. Then one more.

Huberman reports he's never seen this fail. Once you're back on slightly solid ground, then it's time to get to work — because the universe rewards effort, or at least the effort to engage in effort.

The Depth-Height Law

There's a strange law that Huberman has observed: the depth of the pit is often the mirror image of the height of the accomplishment that follows. He doesn't know why it works — maybe it's dopaminergic, maybe it's something else — but the pattern is real. The darker the valley, the higher the peak that follows. So if you're in a deep valley, know that the opposite is being built on the other side.

09

The Immigrant Edge & Identity

Seeing opportunity where others see the ordinary is the ultimate competitive advantage.

Why do immigrants consistently outperform? Huberman's father was a first-generation immigrant to the United States. The pattern he's observed is striking and has a neurological basis.

Immigrants look around and see *opportunity* — everywhere that someone who's been there a long time sees neutral or negative. Where natives have habituated, immigrants have fresh eyes. It's the fighter mentality on a backdrop of people who have attenuated to their environment.

> *"The human brain habituates to a certain level of caloric intake, freedom, ease, and peace. This is why self-imposed friction is very valuable — especially if you come from a family where there is not a lot of hardship."*
>
> — ANDREW HUBERMAN

The Paradox of Too Much Comfort

The most unhappy people Huberman knows from his peer group? Not the ones who struggled. The ones whose parents gave them *just enough* money so they never really had to push themselves. They're the ones with depression, issues of self-worth, and chronic dissatisfaction.

It's good to have your head held under water for a short while — metaphorically — so you can appreciate oxygen when you come up.

Consumer vs. Creator

The simplest daily question to ask yourself: **Am I a consumer or a creator in this moment?**

Spend some time being a creator every day, and you're going to be okay. If you're purely a consumer every day, you'll end up spent. The balance doesn't have to be perfect. But the question itself is a compass.

Better yet: **Become the producer of the thing you consume the most.** Huberman loved research papers — so he became a scientist. He loved podcasts — so he created one. This pattern is reliable across every domain.

10

The Cost of Greatness

Holding intense emotions and relentless ambition inside the same vessel.

When asked "What is the cost of being Andrew Huberman?" — a man who has built one of the world's most influential science platforms, maintained a Stanford professorship, and navigated public life — his answer reveals the deepest tension of a driven life.

> *"I experience emotions very intensely. And I'm also very ambitious. And I have a vision of the world that I want to help contribute to creating. Holding those two things inside can be challenging — and sometimes can be downright agony — because I want to help every single person, drop into every single emotion. But I can't, because I've got work to do."*
>
> — ANDREW HUBERMAN

The Three Times Huberman Felt Powerless

Even someone with his tools, his knowledge, and his platform has been brought to his knees:

1. **His parents' divorce as a child.** His world fragmented. He spiraled into bad situations for years before digging himself out.
2. **Losing all three scientific mentors.** Suicide. Cancer. Cancer. Each loss was devastating. His graduate adviser was like a mother to him. After the third loss, he thought he was cursed. But from that academic orphaning came the freedom to start the podcast.
3. **A failed relationship** where he'd poured his heart and soul — only to realize there were issues he couldn't resolve. Being misunderstood was the hardest part.

In every case, the pattern was the same: feel the pit. Acknowledge it. Then transmute it into something generative. After the third crisis, he looked around and saw his podcast team, his healthy parents in their 80s, his friends, his opportunities — and realized he was sitting in the promised land while staring at the past.

Making Peace

Huberman has made his will. He's thought about mortality. If he dropped dead walking out of any podcast, he'd be okay. Every conversation is an opportunity to learn and teach. Every person he meets is a chance to connect.

This isn't morbid. It's liberating. When you've taken yourself to the edge — but not off the edge — your entire life, you develop a relationship with mortality that removes fear and replaces it with presence.

✨ THE FINAL FRAME

Your life is an adventure. You get to write your own story. Don't compare it to anyone else's painting. Build your own beautiful vision. The world doesn't want another copy of someone who already exists. It wants the one thing only you can create.

"I look forward to the day that someone says: I heard this conversation and I went for it."

A

Appendix: The Complete Playbook

Every protocol, every framework, every tool — on one page.

🌅 Morning Stack (First 30–60 min)

- Get bright light (sunlight or 10,000 lux) — 5–10 min
- Hydrate — 16–32 oz water
- Caffeine — coffee or tea
- Exercise if possible (resistance or cardio)
- 10-breath meditation before getting out of bed
- No phone scrolling in bed

💪 Weekly Exercise Template

- **Sunday:** Long slow cardio (45–60 min jog/cycle/swim)
- **Monday:** Hard leg workout (~1 hour, 2–3 hard sets per exercise)
- **Tuesday:** Rest day (walk + sunlight)
- **Wednesday:** Easy cardio (30 min blood flow)
- **Thursday:** Push/pull upper body (~1 hour, same intensity principle)
- **Friday:** VO2 max training (warm up → 20–30s all-out sprints × 6 rounds)
- **Saturday:** Complete rest or light activity

🌙 Evening Wind-Down (Final Hour)

- Dim all lights
- 3–5 deliberate long exhales
- Cool the room
- No caffeine for 8+ hours prior
- Ashwagandha (300–600mg) if using
- Optional: Magnesium threonate, apigenin, theanine
- If can't sleep: Eye movement proprioceptive reset

🧠 Mental Performance Tools

- **Left/Right Column Exercise** — Monthly
- **Yoga Nidra / NSDR** — 10–30 min, daily or as needed
- **Panoramic Vision Reset** — When feeling overwhelmed
- **Self-Testing** — After learning anything new
- **The Slightly Harder Thing** — Throughout the day
- **Phone Lock Box** — During focus work and workouts
- **Consumer vs. Creator check** — Daily

📊 The Mastery Timeline

- **Years 1–3:** Gas pedal. Go all in. Don't die.
- **Years 4–6:** Dynamic regulation. Find sustainable rhythm.
- **Years 7–10+:** Pro stage. Mastery + playfulness.

What You'll Walk Away With

- ✓ The single most impactful daily behavior for energy, focus, and immunity
- ✓ How to turn off your brain when everyone says push harder
- ✓ The sleep trick that neuroscientists use but never share publicly
- ✓ A 10-year framework for building mastery without burning out
- ✓ Why you choke under pressure — and the counterintuitive fix
- ✓ The concept of clutch states (better than flow)
- ✓ How to transmute any hardship into forward momentum
- ✓ Actionable protocols you can start today — for free

"I was that person going: I don't know if I can do it.
And I went for it. And you can too."

GET THE FULL BLUEPRINT →

Based on the conversation between Dr. Andrew Huberman and Raj Shamani